Autopay Card-Change Analysis Script

Autopay Card-Change Re-Enrollment Analysis — plain English throughout

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Plain-English Summary

Some customers call in about an expired, lost, or replaced payment card, and while they're at it, they turn off autopay instead of just updating their card — usually because they don't have the new card in hand yet. Most turn autopay back on soon after. But a small group never does.

Jonathan asked: are those customers quietly still with us, paying manually, or have they actually left? We pulled every card-related autopay removal, checked which customers didn't re-enroll within 60 days, and looked at what happened to them next.

The good news first: of the 254 customers who removed autopay after a card-change call and never turned it back on, 85% (216 people) are still active customers today — most likely just paying their bill manually. Only 15% (38 people) have actually left us.

But that 15% is a real signal. A typical customer only has about a 5.25% chance of leaving over any 60-day window. So this group is churning at roughly 3 times the normal rate. That's not noise — it's worth paying attention to.

The money at risk, though, is small. Of the 38 customers who left, 31 of them (82%) owed us nothing at all. Only 7 left with any past-due balance, and the total past-due across all 38 was just $1,959.28 — about $52 per customer on average.

The most surprising finding: among the 181 customers who had a valid credit score on file (28 who churned, 153 still active), we expected the customers who left to be our lower-credit, shorter-tenure, higher-risk customers. They weren't. Customers who left actually had a slightly *higher* average credit score (827) than those who stayed (803), and somewhat shorter tenure (664 days vs. 819 days). This looks like ordinary customer turnover, not a credit-risk problem.

We also want to be upfront: 73 of the 254 customers (29%) had no credit score on file and couldn't be included in that comparison — that's its own slide (Slide 8), and there are a few other follow-up angles we haven't checked yet (Slide 9).

This entire analysis covers card-related autopay removals from April 2 to August 8, 2026 — about four months of real records.

How to Walk Through It, Slide by Slide

Assume the audience has no background — explain everything as if for the first time.

Slide 1 — Title

Introduce the topic in one sentence — what happens to customers who don't come back to autopay after a card issue.

Say something like: "Today I want to walk through what happens to customers who turn off autopay after a card problem, and never turn it back on."

Slide 2 — Why We're Doing This

Explain the everyday situation first: when a customer's card expires or gets replaced, some of them turn off autopay entirely instead of just updating their card on file — often simply because they don't have the new card in hand yet.

State what's normal versus what's not: most of these customers turn autopay back on soon after. But a small group never does, and until now, nobody had checked what happens to them.

Explain why it matters: if these customers are quietly still paying us — just manually instead of through autopay — that's not a problem at all. But if they're actually leaving, that's worth knowing and worth doing something about.

Say something like: "When a customer's card expires or gets replaced, some of them turn off autopay instead of updating their card — usually because they don't have the new card yet. Most turn it back on. But a small group doesn't. We wanted to find out: are those customers still with us, or have they actually left?"

Slide 3 — How We Did This

Walk the four steps in plain terms:

Step 1 — Found every card-related autopay removal. We searched real call notes for card-change language — phrases like "expired," "lost," "replaced," "new card" — and matched those calls to autopay removals that happened within about a week of the call.

Step 2 — Checked who came back within 60 days. For each of those customers, we checked our autopay records to see if they turned it back on again within 60 days.

Step 3 — Looked at what happened to the ones who didn't. For customers who never re-enrolled, we checked our customer records to see if they're still an active customer today, or have since left.

Step 4 — Compared this group to a typical customer. We measured how often this specific group leaves compared to a typical customer over the same 60-day window, and also compared their credit scores and how long they'd been a customer.

Mention the tool plainly: everything came from SQL — a way of asking our own company databases direct questions — pulling and cross-checking real records from our billing, autopay, and call systems. Nothing outside our own data, nothing estimated.

Mention the data window if asked: this covers card-related autopay removals from April 2 to August 8, 2026 — about 4 months.

Say something like: “We found every autopay removal tied to a card-change call, checked which of those customers came back within 60 days, and for the ones who didn’t, we checked whether they’re still with us today. Then we compared that group to a typical customer to see if they’re actually riskier. This covers about the last four months — April through early August 2026.”

Slide 4 — Are They Leaving, or Just Paying Manually?

Point at the chart: 85% still active, 15% churned.

Explain the chart’s axes if asked: the bottom shows the two possible outcomes (still active vs. churned), and the height of each bar shows what percentage of the 254 customers fall into each group.

Land the reassuring point first: the large majority of this group is still with us. They almost certainly just switched to paying their bill manually instead of using autopay.

Say something like: “Of the 254 customers who removed autopay after a card-change call and never turned it back on, 85% are still active customers today — most likely just paying manually. Only 15%, or 38 customers, have actually left.”

Slide 5 — Is This Group Riskier Than a Typical Customer?

Important: address this up front, before anyone can be confused by it. This chart is not a pie — the two bars do NOT add up to 100%, and there is no “missing 80%.” These are two separate measurements of the same thing (the chance of leaving within any 60-day window), applied to two different groups of customers:

- **Left bar — “Card-Change Callers Who Never Re-Enrolled (n=254)”:** this is the same 254 customers from Slide 4 — people who called in about a card problem, turned off autopay, and never turned it back on. Of that group, 15% left within 60 days.
- **Right bar — “A Typical Customer (Whole Customer Base)”:** this is a completely different, much larger group — basically any customer, picked at random from our whole customer base, regardless of autopay history. Of that group, about 5% leave in any given 60-day window. This is our baseline for comparison.

If asked “where’s the other 80%?” — that question actually belongs to Slide 4, not this slide. Slide 4 is the complete pie (85% still active + 15% churned = 100% of the 254). This slide takes just the 15%-churned piece of that pie and asks a new question: is 15% actually a lot? To answer that, we need something to compare it to — that’s what the right-hand bar is for. The two bars are not slices of one whole; they’re two independent percentages, side by side, so we can compare them.

Land the real finding: this group is churning at about 3 times the normal rate. That’s a genuine, measurable difference — not something that could happen by chance.

Say something like: “This chart isn’t a pie — the two bars aren’t parts of the same 100%. The left bar is the 254 card-change customers from the last slide; 15% of them left. The right bar is a totally different group — a typical customer from our whole customer base; about 5% of them leave in any 60-day window. So this specific group leaves about 3 times more often than a typical customer. That’s a real signal worth watching.”

Slide 6 — What It’s Costing Us

Explain the goal of this slide: now that we know some of this group actually left, the next question is simple — did they leave owing us money?

Walk the two columns: most (82%) left owing nothing at all. Only 7 of the 38 left with any past-due balance, and the total across all 38 was under $2,000 — about $52 per customer.

Land the business point: this is a real signal, but it is not costing us much today. It doesn’t need urgent action, but it is worth keeping an eye on.

Say something like: “Of the 38 customers who left, 31 of them — 82% — owed us nothing at all. Only 7 left with any past-due balance, and altogether, the total past-due across all 38 was $1,959.28, or about $52 per customer. This is a real signal, but it’s not a costly problem today.”

Slide 7 — Who Are These 38 Customers?

Point at the chart: two groups of bars, one for average credit score, one for average tenure in days, each split by churned vs. still active.

Explain what we expected first, so the surprise lands: we assumed the customers who left would be lower-credit or newer customers — the ones we’d typically consider higher-risk.

Reveal the actual finding: it’s the opposite. Customers who left had a slightly *higher* average credit score (827) than those who stayed (803), and shorter average tenure (664 days vs. 819 days) — though both groups are well-established, long-time customers, not brand-new ones.

Say something like: “We expected this group to skew toward lower credit scores or newer customers — the usual signs of risk. It didn’t. Customers who left actually had a slightly higher credit score than those who stayed, and somewhat shorter tenure. This looks like ordinary turnover, not a credit-risk pattern.”

Slide 8 — How Much of the Group Could We Actually Compare?

Explain why this slide exists: the credit score and tenure comparison on the previous slide didn’t cover the full 254 customers — it’s important to be upfront about exactly how much of the group it does cover.

Point at the pie chart: 71% (181 customers) had a valid credit score on file and are the ones behind the 827-vs-803 comparison. The remaining 29% (73 customers) had no credit score on file at all and could not be included.

Explain why some customers have no credit score on file, if asked: a credit score of exactly zero or a missing value in our system means there’s no score on file for that customer — not that they have bad credit. This can happen for a few reasons (timeout during the credit check, no check run at all, credit frozen, or a “no-hit” where the credit bureau has insufficient information to return a file). We exclude these customers from a credit-score comparison rather than treating them as zero, since a zero would incorrectly drag the average down.

Say something like: “The credit score numbers on the last slide only cover part of the group. Of the 254 customers, 181 — 71% — had a valid credit score on file, and those are the ones behind the 827-versus-803 comparison. The other 73 — 29% — had no credit score on file at all, so they couldn’t be included in that comparison.”

Slide 9 — What We Haven’t Checked Yet

Be upfront: this slide exists so nobody assumes we checked everything. Two honest limits:

What we did check (71% of the group): 181 of the 254 customers had a valid credit score on file and are included in the credit/tenure comparison. Churn status, financial exposure, and the baseline comparison cover the full group of 254.

What’s left to check (the remaining 29%): 73 of the 254 customers had no credit score on file at all and were left out of the credit/tenure comparison. We also haven’t yet checked how many days typically pass between the card-change call and when someone actually leaves, or whether these customers called in — for example about a disconnect — before leaving. And we haven’t confirmed with the Chase account team whether certain card types explain why some cards update automatically on expiration and others don’t.

Say something like: “We want to be upfront about the boundaries of this analysis. We were able to check credit score and tenure for 71% of this group — the other 29% had no credit score on file. And there are a few real follow-up questions we haven’t answered yet, which are on the next-steps slide.”

Slide 10 — Key Findings

Read all four rows as the full wrap-up.

Say something like: “So, putting it all together: most customers who don’t re-enroll are still with us, the ones who do leave churn at about 3 times the normal rate, the money at risk from that group is small, and — the real surprise — it’s not our riskiest customers who are leaving.”

Slide 11 — Questions for Jonathan

Frame this as decisions we need his input on before deciding next steps.

Say something like: “Here are a few things I’d like your direction on before we take this further.”

Slide 12 — Next Steps

Frame as practical, concrete follow-ons.

Say something like: “Here’s what we’d suggest doing next.”

Key Numbers

What We Measured	Result
Total customers who didn’t re-	254

enroll within 60 days	
Still active today	216 (85%)
Churned (actually left)	38 (15%)
Baseline 60-day churn rate (typical customer)	5.25%
This group’s churn rate vs. baseline	~3x higher
Churned customers who owed nothing	31 of 38 (82%)
Churned customers with any past-due balance	7 of 38 (18%)
Total past-due across all 38 churned customers	$1,959.28
Average past-due per churned customer	$51.56
Total amount owed (past-due + current) across all 38	$6,285.25
Average credit score — churned group	827 (n=28)
Average credit score — still-active group	803 (n=153)
Average tenure — churned group	664 days (n=28)
Average tenure — still-active group	819 days (n=153)
Customers excluded from credit/tenure comparison (no score on file)	73 of 254 (29%)
Date range of card-change removals analyzed	April 2 – August 8, 2026 (~4 months)

Next Steps

- Check the timing between the card-change call and churn — how many days typically pass before a non-re-enrolled customer actually leaves. Tells us if this is an early-warning signal or a lagging one.
- Check whether these customers called in before leaving — for example a collections or disconnect-related call — to understand whether the exit was visible to us or a quiet walk-away.
- Confirm the Chase seamless-update mechanism with the Chase account team, so we can confidently segment removals by card type in the future.
- Consider a lightweight re-enrollment reminder, as Remy suggested — given the elevated but low-cost churn signal, a simple reminder may be enough without a major process change.

Questions to Ask

1. Is a 3x-elevated churn rate worth a proactive fix, given the low dollar exposure? Or is this acceptable normal churn?
2. Should we fold in the reminder-communication idea Remy raised — a friendly nudge to re-enroll in autopay — as the direct follow-up action here?
3. Should we prioritize confirming the Chase seamless-update

mechanism before doing any deeper card-type segmentation work?
4. Do you want the 73 excluded customers (no credit score on file) looked at separately, given they're a meaningful 29% of the group?

If They Ask… (Quick Answers)

Q: How did you identify "card-related" autopay removals — is there a clean flag for that in our systems? A: No, there isn't a structured "reason" field for this. We searched the actual written call summaries for card-change language — phrases like "expired card," "lost card," "new card," "update payment method" — and matched those calls to autopay removals that happened within about a week of the call.

Q: How do you know 5.25% is a fair baseline to compare against? A: We took a snapshot of all active Texas residential customers around the same time period as our card-change group, and measured what percentage of them churned over the following 60 days — the same window we used for our group. It's the same measurement, applied to a typical customer instead of this specific group.

Q: Why are 73 customers excluded from the credit-score comparison? A: A credit score of exactly zero, or a missing value, means there's no score on file for that customer — not that they have bad credit. We exclude those so they don't distort the average. It does mean the credit/tenure comparison only covers 71% of the full group.

Q: Is $52 per customer in past-due debt a real number, or an estimate? A: It's a direct count from our billing records — the actual past-due balance on file for each of the 38 churned customers, averaged. Not an estimate.

Q: Could the "customers who left have higher credit scores" finding be a fluke? A: It's based on a real, if modest, sample — 28 churned and 153 still-active customers with valid credit scores. The direction of the finding (higher credit, shorter tenure) is consistent and worth taking seriously, though we'd want to keep an eye on it as more data comes in over time.

Q: Should we be worried about this group? A: Not urgently. The churn rate is genuinely elevated, but the financial exposure is small, and it isn't concentrated in a high-risk segment. It's a good candidate for a low-cost fix like a reminder, not an emergency.

Q: On Slide 5, the bars show 15% and 5% — where's the other 80%? What are those other customers doing? A: There is no "other 80%" on this slide — the two bars aren't parts of the same pie, so they were never meant to add up to 100%. They're two separate measurements of the same question (chance of leaving within 60 days) asked of two different groups: the 254 card-change customers on one side, and a typical customer from our whole customer base on the other. The full breakdown of the 254 card-change customers — including exactly what the other 85% are doing (still active, paying manually) — is on Slide 4, not Slide 5.

Q: The 827 and 803 credit scores on Slide 7 — out of how many customers? A: 827 is the average of 28 churned customers, and 803 is the average of 153 still-active customers — 181 total, which is the 71% of the full 254-customer group that had a valid credit score on file. Slide 8 shows that 71%/29% split directly.

Q: What time period does this whole analysis cover? A: Card-related autopay removals from April 2 to August 8, 2026 — about four months of real records, pulled directly from our billing, autopay, and call systems.